

Open Technology Ecosystem Assessment

Each item can be scored from 1 (Not Met) to 5 (Fully Met) or simply marked Yes/No as appropriate.

1. Total Cost Optimisation

- Is the ecosystem eliminating or significantly reducing license fees?
- Does the ecosystem provide connectors and tools that can help reduce the cost of integrations and customisation of software?
- Are design tools or verification tools available at no cost or open source?
- Are there competitive solutions available at each stage of the lifecycle of the technology?
- Have you compared cost structures for different applications (e.g. low vs. high volume in hardware)?
- Can costs be reduced through reuse of components?
- Can we estimate savings along the full life cycle? With what precisions?

2. Design Flexibility and Speed

- Are non-disclosure agreements or IP-related delays eliminated or simplified?
- Can we rapidly customise the technology?
- Can you quickly prototype or adapt components using ecosystem resources?
- Are configurators or rapid design kits readily available?
- Are supplier interactions faster and less restricted than in proprietary models?
- Is the ecosystem responsive to our development pace?
- Where and when speed can be gained?
- Where and when will the project be slowed down?

3. Stability and Modularity

- Are the core technical components stable, standardised, and maintained?
- Is there a good balance between upgrades and stability?
- Are ecosystem-wide quality assurance and testing tools available?
- Is the architecture modular (e.g. allowing selection of only necessary features)?
- Can components be customised without destabilising the system?
- Can modules be safely extended and interfaced?
- Are certification or compliance processes supported and evolving?
- Can modules be safely extended and interfaced?

4. White Box Transparency

- Is full access to design files and source code guaranteed to everyone?
- Can internal or third-party teams inspect it and verify safety and cybersecurity properties?
- Are all dependencies and contributions traceable and transparent?
- Are intellectual property rights clearly understood and fully documented?

5. Supplier Flexibility

- Are multiple suppliers available for each major component or service?
- Can you switch or dual-source suppliers without incurring high switching costs?
- Are regional or local suppliers available to match sourcing constraints?
- Can the supply chain be adjusted to meet export control or geopolitical requirements?
- Will you retain long-term independence from dominant technology vendors?

6. Permissive Licensing

- Is the technology governed by a permissive licence?
- Does the licence allow proprietary or commercial reuse without contamination?
- Are obligations to contribute back to the ecosystem clearly optional or defined?
- Are any licence terms likely to interfere with your organisation's IP strategy?
- Does your legal or compliance team fully understand the licence implications?

7. Active Ecosystem

- Is the number of members, contributors, or adopters growing over time?
- Are developers actively contributing software, design files, tools, extensions, or documentation?
- Are major industry players publicly supporting or integrating the ecosystem?
- Is the governance structure transparent, inclusive, and functional?
- Are there working groups, or events that drive collaboration?
- Are compliance and certification tools being developed or made available?